

Module 1

Understanding Ethics and Morality



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Understanding Ethics and Morality

OBJECTIVES

At the end of the lesson, the learners are expected to:

1. Students recall and understand the nature of rules and why they are important.
2. Differentiate between moral and non-moral standards.
3. Explore the different branches of ethics and their functions to society and the self.



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Subtopic 1

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ETYMOLOGY: Ethics

- came from the Greek word ***ethos***, meaning custom or a particular behavior.



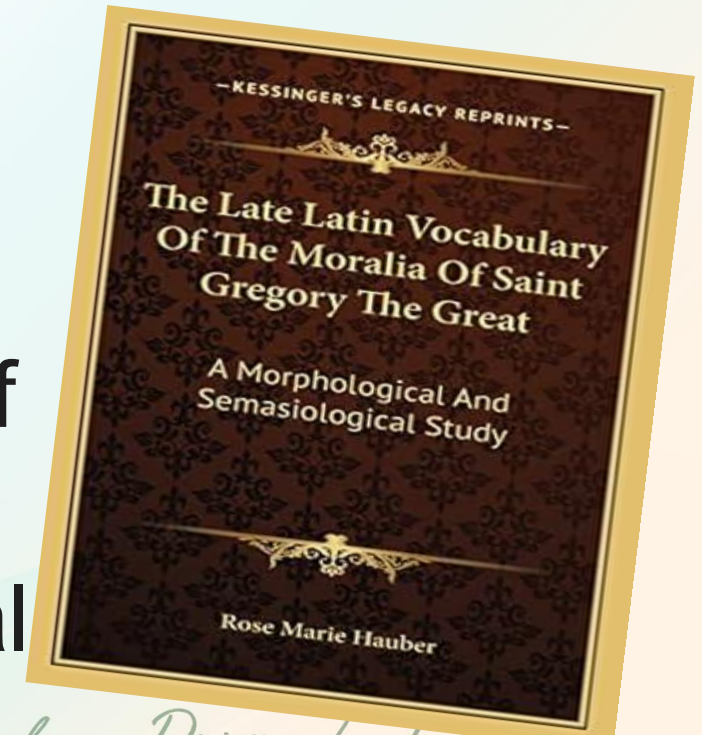
WHAT IS ETHICS?

- A branch of philosophy that studies the rightness and wrongness of human actions.
- Conformity to accepted standards of conduct
- The realm of theory (how people conform to certain ideas of right or wrong).



ETYMOLOGY: Moral

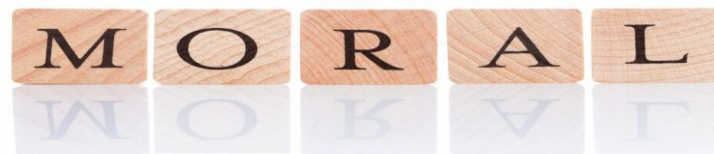
- Comes from the Latin word *moralis*, *mos*, *mor*, meaning 'CUSTOM'. In French, *moralit*.
- As a noun, the word was first used to translate Latin *Moralia*, the title of St. Gregory the Great's moral exposition of the Book of Job. It was subsequently applied to the works of various classical writers.



WHAT IS MORAL?



- ❑ Rightness and wrongness of a human act
- ❑ Actual conformity of people's behavior to standards of right and wrong.
- ❑ It is one's ability and capacity to distinguish right from wrong.
- ❑ The realm of practice (how people live)



OTHER MORAL TERMS/IDEAS

1. Non-Moral
2. Immoral
3. Ammmoral



NON-MORAL



An action that does not imply any moral sense, meaning it isn't about right or wrong.

For example, wondering whether one should eat grapefruit, wear socks of a specific shade of color, or part your hair on the left side of the head are all usually considered nonmoral issues. Yet there are circumstances where such actions could have moral consequences.

Statements in the sciences (so-called "factual statements") are considered to be about nonmoral issues as well



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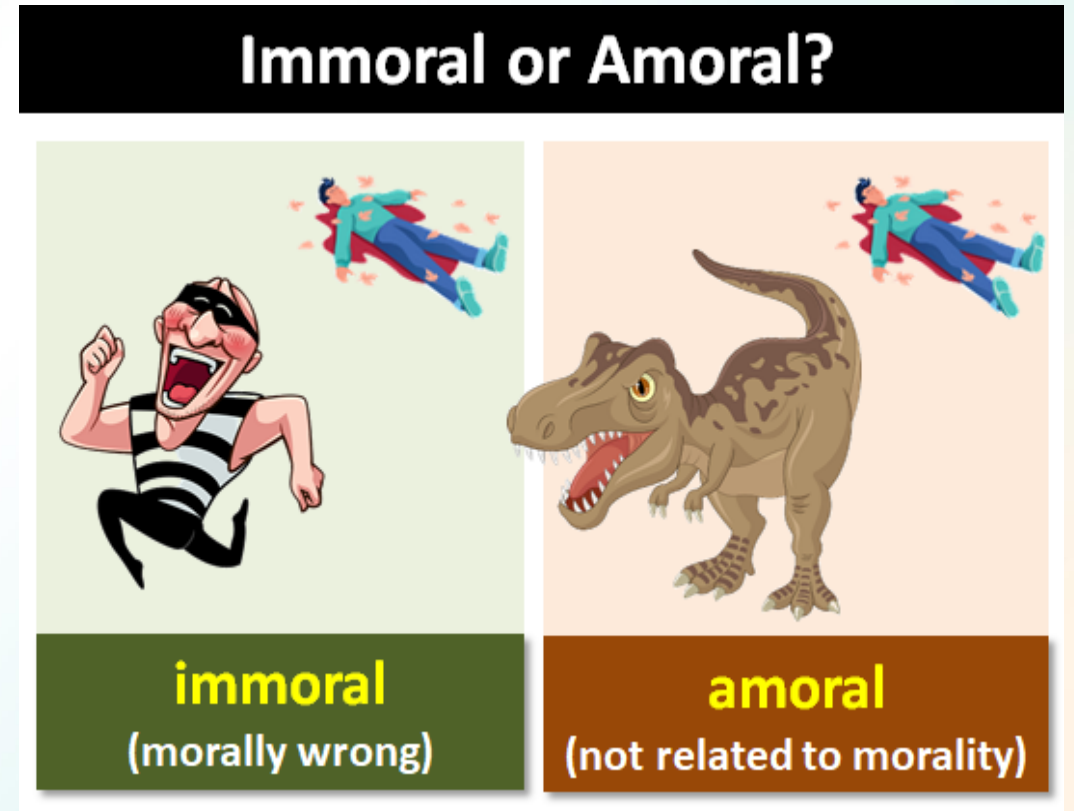
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AMORAL ACTION

- An action that lacks moral sense - it's neither morally right nor morally wrong.

Not concerned with right and wrong

One who does not accept the concept of right and wrong



IMMORAL

- An action that is not in conformity with what is right or wrong (as a universal knowledge)

Violating moral standards



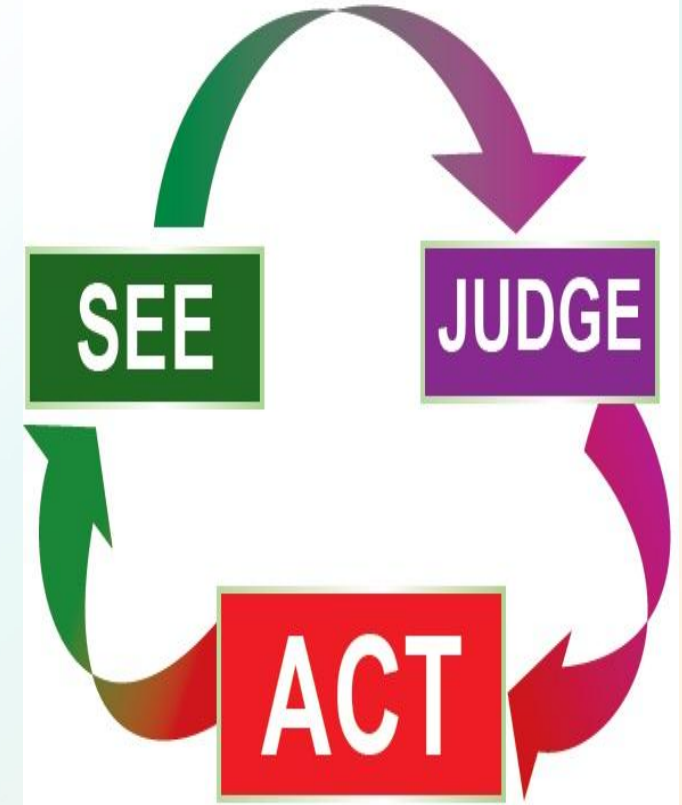
IMPORTANCE OF ETHICS TO MAN AND SOCIETY

- Ethics is a requirement for human life. It is our means of deciding a course of action.
- The study of ethics is essential to the stable functioning of civilization.



How do we judge an ACT?

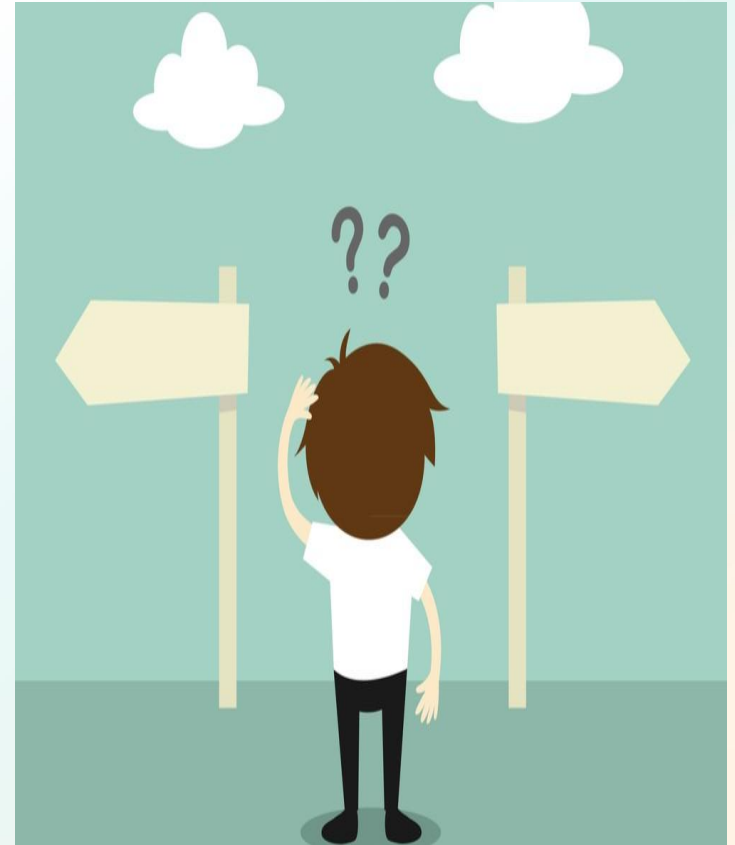
1. Consider the **NATURE OF THE ACT**
(good or bad)
2. Consider the **INTENTION OF THE DOER** (willed or not)
3. Consider the **CIRCUMSTANCES**
around the act (When? Where? What? Who?)



Moral Reasoning & Errors in Thinking

Moral reasoning is the process of thinking about what is right or wrong and deciding what a person should do based on ethical principles.

- ✓ Ethics requires correct reasoning
- ✓ Not all arguments are valid
- ✓ Some reasoning contains logical fallacies



Logical Fallacies

- ☐ Errors in reasoning that weaken arguments.
- ☐ Can make something appear right when it is wrong.
- ☐ Common in everyday moral judgments.



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Logical Fallacies



Ad Hominem (Attack the Person)-
Attacking the person instead of the argument.

"Don't listen to her argument about ethics—she's not even a good student."

Destroys fair moral evaluation and respect for persons.



Bandwagon (Appeal to Popularity) -
Assuming something is right because many people believe it.

"Everyone cheats in exams, so it must be okay."

Confuses popularity with morality.



Hasty Generalization - Making conclusions from insufficient evidence.

"One corrupt leader means all leaders are corrupt."

Promotes prejudice and unjust moral judgments.

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Logical Fallacies



False Dilemma (Either–Or Fallacy) -
Presenting only two options when more exist.

“Either you support your friend’s cheating, or you’re a bad friend.”

Oversimplifies moral decisions,, dangerous in dilemmas.

Straw Man - Misrepresenting someone’s argument to make it easier to attack.

“You said students need mental health breaks—so you want them to stop studying?”

Undermines honest dialogue and truth-seeking.



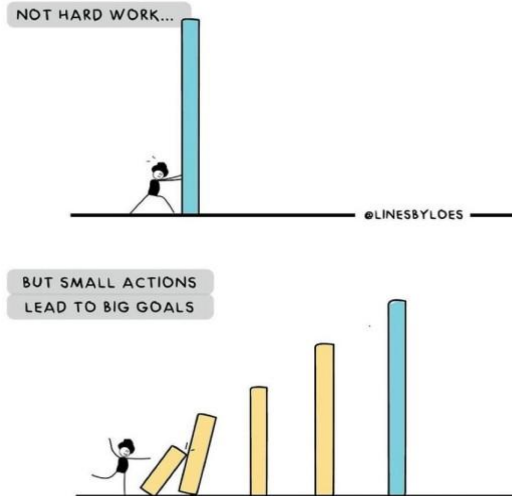
Logical Fallacies



Appeal to Emotion - Using emotions instead of logic

“If you report cheating, you’ll destroy your friend’s future.”

Leads to emotion-driven moral errors.



Slippery Slope - Claiming one action will lead to extreme consequences.

“If we allow one late submission, students will stop submitting work entirely.”

Creates fear-based moral reasoning.

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Why Fallacies Matter in Ethics

- ☐ Leads to wrong moral decisions
- ☐ Encourages bias and unfairness
- ☐ Weakens ethical judgment
- ☐ Makes people vulnerable to manipulation



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WHY IS A HUMAN PERSON A MORAL PERSON

1. He has **INTELLECT/REASON (RATIONAL)** – He knows the truth.
2. He has **WILL (FREEDOM)** – He has **FUNDAMENTAL OPTION** – can freely move towards the good.
3. He has **BODY AND SOUL** - He is an **EMBODIED SPIRIT**.
4. He has **CONSCIENCE** - He has an inner **LIFE AND CORE**.
5. He **HAS POWERS AND CAPACITIES** - He has talents, abilities and can move towards self-enhancement and growth)



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WHY DO WE NEED TO BE MORAL?

1. Because we are NOT ALONE, we live with OTHERS (We affect them, they affect us)
2. There is THE OTHER that demands from us (We create standards for stable functioning).
3. It brings about peaceful coexistence in the world.



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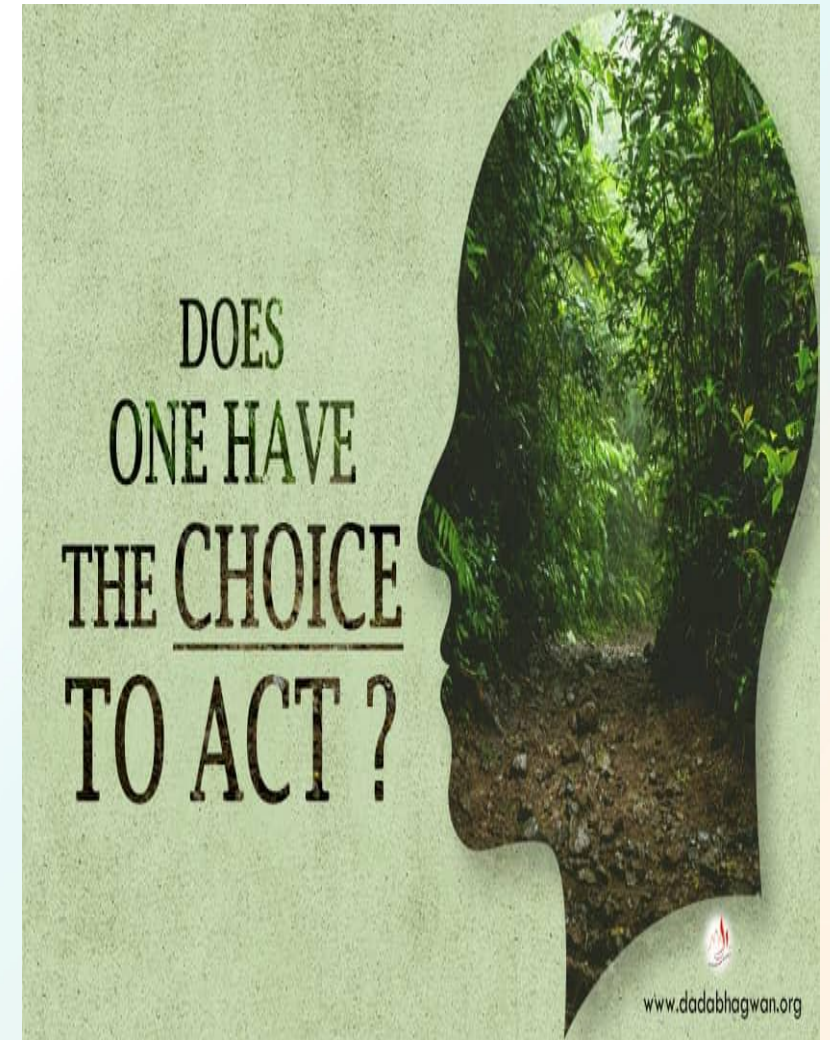


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Therefore,

- ***Moral acts*** are acts that consider others
- ***Immoral acts*** are acts that are too self-serving/
inconsiderate of others



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